

Hitachi Prepares The Terabyte

Close to the 50th anniversary of the hard disk, Hitachi is poised to release the first 1000 GB hard drive by the end of this year. The drives will use the new Perpendicular Storage technology. Seagate is currently shipping the world's largest 3.5-inch drive, with a capacity of 750 GB



Firefox 2.0 Delayed

The September 26 release of the popular browser has been pushed to October 24. A late release is better, they say, than a buggy one. According to the project's latest bug list, there are 87 bugs that still need to be ironed out



Enter

Kailash Kher
Singer

With *Allah ke bandey* and *Mangal Mangal*, Kailash Kher's voice has touched many hearts and received acclaim from around the globe. He is a playback singer, music composer and actor as well. Recently, his voice in the background score of *Fanaa* sent audiences into a trance...

Technology to you is...

....kind of a life-line to me today. It is playing an important role in my personal as well as professional life. I believe it is a boon to mankind.

What are your favourite gadgets?

I am not a very gadget-friendly person, but I do use a Nokia Communicator and an Apple iPod. I recently got myself a Nokia N-series cell phone.

What do you do online?

The majority of my time is devoted to *riyaaz*, and in my free time I observe silence. So I don't get online much. But I do check my mail frequently and surf for information when required.

Any particular instance where technology came to your rescue?

For me, every day is memorable, and technology has helped me a lot. It's an injustice to mention any one incident... Once a producer wanted me to send him my photos and profile, and luckily I was using my Communicator. I was able to send him my full details by e-mail. It's been like a minicomputer for me. I would like to add that technology should be used for the growth and development of mankind, and not misused.

THE GIANT GROWS... SMALLER

The End Of E3 As We Know It

It's true—the massive Electronic Entertainment Expo (E3), otherwise known as gamer heaven, has crumbled under its own weight and collapsed; it will give way to a smaller, toned down version of itself, and will now be held in July instead of May. The news comes in the wake of the pulling out of four of the biggest exhibitors in the expo—Microsoft, Electronic Arts (EA), Nintendo and Sony Computer Entertainment America (SCEA).

It has almost unanimously been agreed industry-wide that the event is more trouble than it's worth. The tremendous budgets (in the vicinity of \$50 million), the planning efforts, the pressure to get game demos done before May, and finally the notion of “winning E3”—having your product noticed the most. Developers and publishers would rather invest in their own self-focused events to get themselves noticed. E3 will now be a platform for smaller companies who don't have the million dollar budgets that it takes to promote a new game. The event has also been shifted to July, which gives developers more time to create their demos—games showcased at E3 are usually those that are slated for release in the November-December holiday

season, and the new date will ensure demos that are less buggy and closer to the final form of the game.

While the community expresses shock over the news, it isn't entirely unexpected, given the way the scenario has changed—while the original purpose of the event was to provide a window of media exposure



for games and the industry in general, it's become unnecessary now. Gaming media is *always* following the industry, so E3 or no E3, people will generally be kept happy.

Ultimately, though, it's still all about the money—there are much cheaper ways to get your product in the hands of people than shelling out \$10 million and making journalists and bloggers stand in a queue all day for a 20-second preview.

EXPLODING LAPS

Dell Recalls Fire-breathing Batteries

Following reports about strange goings-on in the Dell laptop world, including photos surfacing of one Dell laptop spontaneously exploding at a conference in Japan late June as well as one going off in Singapore late July, Dell and the U.S. Consumer Product Safety Commission have finally decided to begin recalling the 4.1 million laptop batteries sold on their Inspiron, Latitude Precision and XPS products between April 2004 and July 2006, making it the largest battery recall in history.

The explosions have been traced to the Lithium ion (Li-ion) batteries, manufactured by Sony, used in the laptops. Li-ion batteries pack more than twice the energy of Nickel-Cadmium or Nickel-Metal Hydride batteries, making them last longer. What's going wrong with them is quite the same that went wrong with mobile phone batteries not too long ago—impurities (mostly small pieces of metal) in the anode and cathode of the battery reach the edge of the electrode and end up damaging the barrier